# SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

**12 April 2021 · Shift 3**

65 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 35 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

## English Language 24 questions

**Q.1**

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Bias

**(A)** Prejudice
**(B)** Stage
**(C)** Prestige
**(D)** Fairness

**Q.2**

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Someone who studies elections and voting statistics

**(A)** Analyst
**(B)** Mathematician
**(C)** Psychologist
**(D)** Psephologist

**Q.3**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To be all ears

**(A)** To be inquisitive and curious
**(B)** To have extra-large ears
**(C)** To be ready and eager to listen
**(D)** To be impatient about something

**Q.4**

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The project is / tough and I / can't be able to / complete it by Monday.

**(A)** can't be able to
**(B)** tough and I
**(C)** complete it by Monday
**(D)** The project is

**Q.5**

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

**(A)** Procure
**(B)** Destractsion
**(C)** Provoke
**(D)** Kindle

**Q.6**

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. We will definitely win the match / this time because our team / has prepare well.

**(A)** We will definitely win the match
**(B)** No error
**(C)** this time because our team
**(D)** has prepare well

**Q.7**

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the right order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. The main activity of Palampur is farming and 80 families of the upper caste own the majority of land in Palampur. B. Palampur village has around 450 families which belong to different castes and creeds. C. The neighboring towns of the village are well connected and all-weather roads are also well connected. D. There are other activities in Palampur like dairy, transport, small-scale manufacturing, etc. which also help run the economy in the village.

**(A)** BADC
**(B)** ABDC
**(C)** CABD
**(D)** CDAB

**Q.8**

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. "Seldom do we find" so many birds nesting during this season.

**(A)** No substitution required
**(B)** Seldom does we find
**(C)** Seldom did we found
**(D)** Seldom we do find

**Q.9**

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Fritter

**(A)** Hoard
**(B)** Waste
**(C)** Spoil
**(D)** Spread

**Q.10**

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. This training programme for students will help the _____ understand the different methods of communication.

**(A)** critics
**(B)** participants
**(C)** trainers
**(D)** organizers

**Q.11**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Bolster

**(A)** Discourage
**(B)** Strengthen
**(C)** Weaken
**(D)** Embolden

**Q.12**

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in the active or passive voice. The central team visited eight villages in the state to assess the damage to the crops.

**(A)** The damage to the crops was assessed in eight villages in the state by the central team.
**(B)** Eight villages in the state were visited by the central team to assess the damage to the crops.
**(C)** Eight villages had visited the central team to assess the damage to the crops.
**(D)** The central team assessed the damage to the crops in eight villages in the state.

**Q.14**

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. I cannot understand "that you" are trying to say.

**(A)** which you
**(B)** what you
**(C)** No substitution required
**(D)** who you

**Q.15**

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Doing something awkwardly or in a clumsy manner

**(A)** Hastening
**(B)** Faltering
**(C)** Fumbling
**(D)** Stumbling

**Q.16**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the idiomatic expression given. Caught red-handed

**(A)** Caught in the act of doing something illegal
**(B)** Caught with a hand covered in blood
**(C)** Caught by someone wearing a red wristband
**(D)** Caught stealing red objects like apples and tomatoes

**Q.17**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Random

**(A)** Planned
**(B)** Reasonable
**(C)** Definite
**(D)** Arbitrary

**Q.18**

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the right order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. Understanding a printed text comes from the interaction between printed words and one's prior knowledge of the world. B. Comprehension is the ability or process of understanding something that is spoken or written. C. Listening comprehension, however, involves multiple processes in understanding and making sense of spoken language. D. In active reading, readers think about their reading, and make connections and inferences.

**(A)** BDCA
**(B)** DACB
**(C)** ADBC
**(D)** BADC

**Q.19**

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech. "Where did the children leave their record books?" the sports coach asked the class prefect.

**(A)** The sports coach asked the class prefect where the children had left their record books.
**(B)** The sports coach asked the class prefect where the children leave their record books.
**(C)** The sports coach asked the class prefect where have the children left their record books.
**(D)** The sports coach asked the class prefect where the children are leaving their record books.

**Q.20**

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. Have you checked if we have _____ information about the location?

**(A)** inadequate
**(B)** profuse
**(C)** insufficient
**(D)** sufficient

**Q.21**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the 19th century, there was an industrial revolution in Europe. As a result, millions of people left the (1) _____ and went to work in big factories in cities. Today, it is the reverse. In several major cities, people have started moving out. Why? They want a cleaner, (2) _____ environment. There are fewer jobs in 'heavy' industries like steel and power generation. (3) _____, there are more jobs in service industries like banking, tourism and food delivery. Besides, modern transport and communications have made it easier for people to (4) _____ to work or even work from home. The result of this revolution in the 21st century will be 'spread cities' – cities are growing fast, but (5) _____, away from city centres and people are choosing to live 40, 50 or 60 kilometres away.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

**(A)** countries
**(B)** cities
**(C)** factories
**(D)** countryside

**Q.22**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the 19th century, there was an industrial revolution in Europe. As a result, millions of people left the (1) _____ and went to work in big factories in cities. Today, it is the reverse. In several major cities, people have started moving out. Why? They want a cleaner, (2) _____ environment. There are fewer jobs in 'heavy' industries like steel and power generation. (3) _____, there are more jobs in service industries like banking, tourism and food delivery. Besides, modern transport and communications have made it easier for people to (4) _____ to work or even work from home. The result of this revolution in the 21st century will be 'spread cities' – cities are growing fast, but (5) _____, away from city centres and people are choosing to live 40, 50 or 60 kilometres away.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

**(A)** brighter
**(B)** darker
**(C)** greener
**(D)** worse

**Q.23**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the 19th century, there was an industrial revolution in Europe. As a result, millions of people left the (1) _____ and went to work in big factories in cities. Today, it is the reverse. In several major cities, people have started moving out. Why? They want a cleaner, (2) _____ environment. There are fewer jobs in 'heavy' industries like steel and power generation. (3) _____, there are more jobs in service industries like banking, tourism and food delivery. Besides, modern transport and communications have made it easier for people to (4) _____ to work or even work from home. The result of this revolution in the 21st century will be 'spread cities' – cities are growing fast, but (5) _____, away from city centres and people are choosing to live 40, 50 or 60 kilometres away.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

**(A)** Instead
**(B)** Clearly
**(C)** Nevertheless
**(D)** Of course

**Q.24**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the 19th century, there was an industrial revolution in Europe. As a result, millions of people left the (1) _____ and went to work in big factories in cities. Today, it is the reverse. In several major cities, people have started moving out. Why? They want a cleaner, (2) _____ environment. There are fewer jobs in 'heavy' industries like steel and power generation. (3) _____, there are more jobs in service industries like banking, tourism and food delivery. Besides, modern transport and communications have made it easier for people to (4) _____ to work or even work from home. The result of this revolution in the 21st century will be 'spread cities' – cities are growing fast, but (5) _____, away from city centres and people are choosing to live 40, 50 or 60 kilometres away.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

**(A)** calculate
**(B)** compute
**(C)** communicate
**(D)** commute

**Q.25**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In the 19th century, there was an industrial revolution in Europe. As a result, millions of people left the (1) _____ and went to work in big factories in cities. Today, it is the reverse. In several major cities, people have started moving out. Why? They want a cleaner, (2) _____ environment. There are fewer jobs in 'heavy' industries like steel and power generation. (3) _____, there are more jobs in service industries like banking, tourism and food delivery. Besides, modern transport and communications have made it easier for people to (4) _____ to work or even work from home. The result of this revolution in the 21st century will be 'spread cities' – cities are growing fast, but (5) _____, away from city centres and people are choosing to live 40, 50 or 60 kilometres away.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

**(A)** inwards
**(B)** upwards
**(C)** outwards
**(D)** downwards

## General Intelligence 16 questions

**Q.1**

Four numbers have been given in the options, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the number that is different.

**(A)** 2704
**(B)** 1948
**(C)** 2116
**(D)** 1936

**Q.3**

Select the correct option that indicates the arrangement of the given words in a logical and meaningful order. 1. Armlet 2. Belt 3. Ascot 4. Socks 5. Turban

**(A)** 3-5-1-4-2
**(B)** 1-2-5-3-4
**(C)** 5-3-1-2-4
**(D)** 3-2-1-5-4

**Q.4**

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. 173 : 125 : 85

**(A)** 365 : 293 : 229
**(B)** 285 : 221 : 135
**(C)** 259 : 199 : 147
**(D)** 293 : 228 : 171

**Q.5**

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given series will complete the series. _ S _ E _ S Z _ F S _ E

**(A)** F E S Z E
**(B)** Z F S E Z
**(C)** F Z F E Z
**(D)** F S E Z F

**Q.7**

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 56, 56, 54, 162, 158, ?

**(A)** 790
**(B)** 830
**(C)** 268
**(D)** 456

**Q.8**

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. Googley : Cricket :: Gambit : ?

**(A)** Basketball
**(B)** Football
**(C)** Cycling
**(D)** Chess

**Q.10**

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term. TAMPO : SCJTJ :: FIFTY : ?

**(A)** EKCYS
**(B)** EKDXU
**(C)** EKCXT
**(D)** ELBXT

**Q.12**

In a certain code language, NAMELY is coded as 74 and MANAGE is coded as 45. How will MUSHER be coded in that language?

**(A)** 88
**(B)** 72
**(C)** 80
**(D)** 68

**Q.13**

Manyak is the son of Aravind. Manyak and Kashyap are brothers. Durga is the mother of Kashyap. Sanhit is the brother of Aravind. Hruday is the son of Sanhit. How is Hruday related to Kashyap?

**(A)** Son-in-law
**(B)** Cousin
**(C)** Son
**(D)** Uncle

**Q.15**

Which two numbers should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? $25 \times 7 + 20 - 40 \div 4 = 210$

**(A)** 20 and 7
**(B)** 25 and 20
**(C)** 20 and 40
**(D)** 40 and 25

**Q.18**

Select the option in which the numbers share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of numbers. 93 : 87

**(A)** 96 : 92
**(B)** 64 : 61
**(C)** 58 : 55
**(D)** 49 : 53

**Q.20**

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some insects are animals. Some animals are frogs. All frogs are cats. Conclusions: I. Some cats are frogs. II. Some frogs are animals. III. Some animals are insects.

**(A)** Only conclusions II and III follow
**(B)** All conclusions follow
**(C)** Only conclusions I and III follow
**(D)** Only conclusions I and II follow

**Q.21**

Four letter-clusters have been given in the options, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the letter-cluster that is different.

**(A)** JNRV
**(B)** FKOR
**(C)** RWAD
**(D)** LQUX

**Q.22**

In a certain code language, 'PENCIL' is written as 'CEILNP' and 'FROST' is written as 'FORST'. How will 'DUSTBIN' be written in that language?

**(A)** BDNISTU
**(B)** BDINSUT
**(C)** BDINSTU
**(D)** DIBNSTU

**Q.23**

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (4, 25, 105)

**(A)** (14, 50, 180)
**(B)** (26, 52, 275)
**(C)** (34, 52, 166)
**(D)** (12, 22, 87)

**Q.24**

Select the option in which the words share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of words. Papaya : Vitamin C

**(A)** Carrot : Vitamin B
**(B)** Apple : Vitamin D
**(C)** Gooseberry : Vitamin C
**(D)** Guava : Vitamin A

## General Awareness 25 questions

**Q.1**

When was the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI) established in India?

**(A)** 1952
**(B)** 1948
**(C)** 1939
**(D)** 1927

**Q.2**

How many monasteries and temples are there in Ellora caves?

**(A)** 34
**(B)** 32
**(C)** 33
**(D)** 31

**Q.3**

Which was the first Indian institution to receive the United Nations Population Award for 2020?

**(A)** Kutumb Foundation
**(B)** Child Rights and You
**(C)** Childline India
**(D)** HelpAge India

**Q.4**
Phodong Monastery is located in _____.

**(A)** Sikkim
**(B)** Bihar
**(C)** Madhya Pradesh
**(D)** Ladakh

**Q.5**
_____ was the Mughal emperor during the revolt of 1857.

**(A)** Akbar II
**(B)** Shah Alam II
**(C)** Bahadur Shah II
**(D)** Bahadur Shah I

**Q.6**
Which of the following state governments launched the 'Digital Seva Setu Programme' for rural areas in October 2020?

**(A)** Maharashtra
**(B)** Bihar
**(C)** Gujarat
**(D)** Uttar Pradesh

**Q.7**
Which of the following is the output device of a computer?

**(A)** Plotter
**(B)** Pen drive
**(C)** Joystick
**(D)** Scanner

**Q.8**
Which of the following states leads in sunflower cultivation?

**(A)** Karnataka
**(B)** Rajasthan
**(C)** Punjab
**(D)** Uttar Pradesh

**Q.9**
In 1959, the Central Government of India undertook the governance in Kerala under _____ of the Constitution of India.

**(A)** Article 356
**(B)** Article 352
**(C)** Article 360
**(D)** Article 349

**Q.10**
A file with the _____ file extension is a Word Open XML Macro-Enabled Document file.

**(A)** .docm
**(B)** .docx
**(C)** .org
**(D)** .pdf

**Q.11**
In August 2020, who was promoted to ICC’s international panel of umpires?

**(A)** Kumar Dharmasena
**(B)** KN Ananthapadmanabhan
**(C)** Sundaram Ravi
**(D)** Anil Chaudhary

**Q.12**
Which of the following organisations awards the Nobel Memorial Prize in Economic Sciences?

**(A)** Swedish Academy
**(B)** Karolinska Institute
**(C)** Norwegian Nobel Committee
**(D)** The Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences

**Q.13**
_____ was the first person who discovered cells.

**(A)** Robert Hooke
**(B)** Francis Crick
**(C)** Alexander Fleming
**(D)** Ernest Rutherford

**Q.14**
Which of the following formulas related to monetary and liquidity aggregates is NOT correct?

**(A)** M1 = Currency (notes + coins) + Demand deposits
**(B)** M4 = M3 + Total deposits with post office savings organisations (excluding national savings certificates)
**(C)** M2 = M1 + Savings deposits with post office savings banks
**(D)** M3 = M1 + Net time deposits of post office savings

**Q.15**
What is the tenure of the chairman of the State Public Service Commission?

**(A)** 6 years or the age of 60 years, whichever is earlier
**(B)** 5 years or the age of 60 years, whichever is earlier
**(C)** 5 years or the age of 65 years, whichever is earlier
**(D)** 6 years or the age of 62 years, whichever is earlier

**Q.16**
Which of the following waterfalls is located in Jharkhand?

**(A)** Jog waterfalls
**(B)** Chulia waterfall
**(C)** Dudhsagar waterfall
**(D)** Hundru waterfall

**Q.17**
Manitombi Singh was a _____ player from Manipur.

**(A)** cricket
**(B)** football
**(C)** volleyball
**(D)** hockey

**Q.18**
Sardar Sarovar Dam is situated in the state of _____ and on the river _____.

**(A)** Gujarat, Narmada
**(B)** Maharashtra, Krishna
**(C)** Uttar Pradesh, Ganga
**(D)** Rajasthan, Chambal

**Q.19**
Leprosy is caused by a bacterium called:

**(A)** Mycobacterium leprae
**(B)** Neisseria gonorrhoeae
**(C)** Mycobacterium tuberculosis
**(D)** Haemophilus pertussis

**Q.20**
A large area of land demarcated as Damin-i-Koh in 1832 was declared as the land of the _____.

**(A)** Santhals
**(B)** Murias
**(C)** Warlis
**(D)** Paharias

**Q.21**
Which of the following institutes got the first rank in the Atal Ranking of Institutions on Innovation Achievements (ARIIA) 2020 in the category of 'Institute of National Importance'?

**(A)** Indian Institute of Technology Madras
**(B)** Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur
**(C)** Indian Institute of Technology Delhi
**(D)** Indian Institute of Technology Mumbai

**Q.22**
Enzyme linked immuno-sorbent assay is a technique used in detection of which of the following diseases?

**(A)** Acquired immunodeficiency syndrome (AIDS)
**(B)** Kidney cancer
**(C)** Malaria
**(D)** Rheumatoid arthritis

**Q.23**

Which is the largest of the following Duns with an approximate length of 35-45 km and a width of 22-25 km?

**(A)** Kota Dun
**(B)** Nalagarh Dun
**(C)** Harike Dun
**(D)** Dehra Dun

**Q.24**

India's first 'Fire Park' was set up at _____ in January 2021.

**(A)** Kolkata
**(B)** Bhopal
**(C)** Bhubaneswar
**(D)** Hyderabad

**Q.25**

Who among the following persons secured the fourth position in the Dhaka Marathon 2021?

**(A)** Angela Jim Asunde
**(B)** Dutee Chand
**(C)** Jigmet Dolma
**(D)** Pushpa Bhandari

# Answer key

### English Language

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(D)** | Q.2 **(D)** | Q.3 **(C)** | Q.4 **(A)** | Q.5 **(B)** | Q.6 **(D)** |
| Q.7 **(A)** | Q.8 **(A)** | Q.9 **(A)** | Q.10 **(B)** | Q.11 **(B)** | Q.12 **(B)** |
| Q.14 **(B)** | Q.15 **(C)** | Q.16 **(A)** | Q.17 **(D)** | Q.18 **(D)** | Q.19 **(A)** |
| Q.20 **(D)** | Q.21 **(D)** | Q.22 **(C)** | Q.23 **(A)** | Q.24 **(D)** | Q.25 **(C)** |

### General Intelligence

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(B)** | Q.3 **(C)** | Q.4 **(A)** | Q.5 **(C)** | Q.7 **(A)** | Q.8 **(D)** |
| Q.10 **(C)** | Q.12 **(A)** | Q.13 **(B)** | Q.15 **(C)** | Q.18 **(C)** | Q.20 **(B)** |
| Q.21 **(A)** | Q.22 **(C)** | Q.23 **(A)** | Q.24 **(C)** | | |

### General Awareness

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(D)** | Q.2 **(A)** | Q.3 **(D)** | Q.4 **(A)** | Q.5 **(C)** | Q.6 **(C)** |
| Q.7 **(A)** | Q.8 **(A)** | Q.9 **(A)** | Q.10 **(A)** | Q.11 **(B)** | Q.12 **(D)** |
| Q.13 **(A)** | Q.14 **(D)** | Q.15 **(D)** | Q.16 **(D)** | Q.17 **(B)** | Q.18 **(A)** |
| Q.19 **(A)** | Q.20 **(A)** | Q.21 **(A)** | Q.22 **(A)** | Q.23 **(D)** | Q.24 **(C)** |
| Q.25 **(C)** | | | | | |

## Explanations

### English Language

**Q.1 · Answer (D) Fairness**

'Bias' is an unfair leaning for or against someone; its opposite is 'fairness'. 'Prejudice' is close to a synonym.

**Q.2 · Answer (D) Psephologist**

A psephologist studies elections and voting patterns.

**Q.3 · Answer (C) To be ready and eager to listen**

'To be all ears' is to listen eagerly and attentively.

**Q.4 · Answer (A) can't be able to**

'Can't' already expresses inability, so 'can't be able to' says it twice: 'I can't complete it' or 'I won't be able to complete it'.

**Q.5 · Answer (B) Destractsion**

The correct spelling is 'distraction'.

**Q.6 · Answer (D) has prepare well**

The present perfect takes the past participle: 'has prepared well'.

**Q.7 · Answer (A) BADC**

B introduces the village and its families, A gives its main activity, farming, and who owns the land, D adds its other activities, and C closes with its links to neighbouring towns: BADC.

**Q.8 · Answer (A) No substitution required**

After a negative adverb such as 'seldom' at the start of a sentence, the auxiliary comes before the subject: 'Seldom do we find' is correct as it stands.

**Q.9 · Answer (A) Hoard**

To 'fritter' money or time is to waste it bit by bit; the opposite is to 'hoard' it.

**Q.10 · Answer (B) participants**

A training programme helps those taking part in it, the 'participants'.

**Q.11 · Answer (B) Strengthen**

To 'bolster' is to support or 'strengthen'.

**Q.12 · Answer (B) Eight villages in the state were visited by the central team to assess the damage to the crops.**

The simple past 'visited' becomes 'were visited', with the object 'eight villages' as the new subject and 'by the central team' as the agent.

**Q.14 · Answer (B) what you**

The object of 'understand' is the thing being said, so 'what you are trying to say'.

**Q.15 · Answer (C) Fumbling**

To 'fumble' is to handle something or do it clumsily.

**Q.16 · Answer (A) Caught in the act of doing something illegal**

To be 'caught red-handed' is to be caught in the act of doing wrong.

**Q.17 · Answer (D) Arbitrary**

'Random' means without plan or pattern: 'arbitrary'.

**Q.18 · Answer (D) BADC**

B defines comprehension, A explains how a printed text is understood, D adds active reading, and C turns, with 'however', to listening comprehension: BADC.

**Q.19 · Answer (A) The sports coach asked the class prefect where the children had left their record books.**
The question becomes a statement in reported speech ('where the children had left', no inversion), and the past 'did ... leave' moves back to the past perfect 'had left'.

**Q.20 · Answer (D) sufficient**
The check is whether there is enough information: 'sufficient'.

**Q.21 · Answer (D) countryside**
People 'left the countryside' to work in factories in the cities.

**Q.22 · Answer (C) greener**
A 'cleaner, greener' environment: the opposite of the industrial city they are leaving.

**Q.23 · Answer (A) Instead**
'Instead' introduces what has replaced the lost jobs in heavy industry: more jobs in services.

**Q.24 · Answer (D) commute**
To 'commute' is to travel regularly between home and work.

**Q.25 · Answer (C) outwards**
'Spread cities' grow 'outwards', away from the city centres.

### General Intelligence

**Q.1 · Answer (B) 1948**
$2704 = 52^2$, $2116 = 46^2$ and $1936 = 44^2$ are perfect squares; 1948 is not.

**Q.3 · Answer (C) 5-3-1-2-4**
From head to foot: turban (head), ascot (a broad scarf worn at the neck), armlet (upper arm), belt (waist) and socks (feet): 5-3-1-2-4.

**Q.4 · Answer (A) 365 : 293 : 229**
Each number is 4 more than the square of an odd number, the odd numbers falling by 2: $173 = 13^2 + 4$, $125 = 11^2 + 4$, $85 = 9^2 + 4$. Likewise $365 = 19^2 + 4$, $293 = 17^2 + 4$, $229 = 15^2 + 4$.

**Q.5 · Answer (C) F Z F E Z**
With F, Z, F, E, Z in the blanks the block FSZE repeats: FSZE FSZE FSZE.

**Q.7 · Answer (A) 790**
The terms are multiplied by 1, reduced by 2, multiplied by 3, reduced by 4 and multiplied by 5 in turn: $56 \times 1 = 56$, $56 - 2 = 54$, $54 \times 3 = 162$, $162 - 4 = 158$ and $158 \times 5 = 790$.

**Q.8 · Answer (D) Chess**
A googly is a kind of delivery bowled in cricket; a gambit is a kind of opening in chess.

**Q.10 · Answer (C) EKCXT**
The letters move −1, +2, −3, +4, −5: TAMPO → SCJTJ. So FIFTY → E K C X T: EKCXT.

**Q.12 · Answer (A) 88**
Each code is the sum of the letters' positions in the alphabet plus 4: NAMELY = 70 + 4 = 74 and MANAGE = 41 + 4 = 45. MUSHER = 13 + 21 + 19 + 8 + 5 + 18 = 84, and 84 + 4 = 88.

**Q.13 · Answer (B) Cousin**
Manyak and Kashyap are brothers and Manyak is Aravind's son, so Kashyap is Aravind's son too. Hruday is the son of Sanhit, Aravind's brother, so he is Kashyap's cousin.

**Q.15 · Answer (C) 20 and 40**
Interchanging 20 and 40: $25 \times 7 + 40 - 20 \div 4 = 175 + 40 - 5 = 210$.

**Q.18 · Answer (C) 58 : 55**
The second number is the first minus the difference of its digits: $93 - (9 - 3) = 87$. Likewise $58 - (8 - 5) = 55$; the others fail ($96 - 3 = 93$, $64 - 2 = 62$, $49 - 5 = 44$).

**Q.20 · Answer (B) All conclusions follow**
All frogs are cats, so some cats are frogs (I). 'Some animals are frogs' and 'some insects are animals' convert to 'some frogs are animals' (II) and 'some animals are insects' (III). All three follow.

**Q.21 · Answer (A) JNRV**
In FKOR, RWAD and LQUX the letters move +5, +4, +3 (W + 4 wraps round to A). JNRV moves +4, +4, +4, so it is the odd one.

**Q.22 · Answer (C) BDINSTU**
The letters of each word are rearranged in alphabetical order: PENCIL → CEILNP and FROST → FORST. So DUSTBIN → BDINSTU.

**Q.23 · Answer (A) (14, 50, 180)**
The third number is five times the difference of the first two: (25 – 4) × 5 = 105. Likewise (50 – 14) × 5 = 180.

**Q.24 · Answer (C) Gooseberry : Vitamin C**
Papaya is a rich source of vitamin C, and so is gooseberry (amla). Carrots are known for vitamin A rather than B, guavas for vitamin C rather than A, and apples contain no vitamin D.

### General Awareness

**Q.1 · Answer (D) 1927**
The Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry was founded in 1927, with G. D. Birla and Purshottamdas Thakurdas among its founders.

**Q.2 · Answer (A) 34**
The Ellora caves in Maharashtra are 34 monasteries and temples: 12 Buddhist, 17 Hindu and 5 Jain.

**Q.3 · Answer (D) HelpAge India**
HelpAge India, which works for older people, received the UN Population Award for 2020 in the institutional category, the first Indian organisation to win it in that category.

**Q.4 · Answer (A) Sikkim**
Phodong Monastery, a Buddhist monastery, is in North Sikkim.

**Q.5 · Answer (C) Bahadur Shah II**
Bahadur Shah II (Bahadur Shah Zafar), the last Mughal emperor, was proclaimed their leader by the rebels of 1857 and was exiled to Rangoon afterwards.

**Q.6 · Answer (C) Gujarat**
Gujarat launched Digital Seva Setu in October 2020 to bring government services online to its villages.

**Q.7 · Answer (A) Plotter**
A plotter prints drawings and graphs, so it is an output device. Joysticks and scanners are input devices and a pen drive is storage.

**Q.8 · Answer (A) Karnataka**
Karnataka is India's leading producer of sunflower.

**Q.9 · Answer (A) Article 356**
In 1959 President's Rule was imposed in Kerala under Article 356 and E. M. S. Namboodiripad's government was dismissed.

**Q.10 · Answer (A) .docm**
'.docm' is Word's macro-enabled Open XML format; an ordinary '.docx' file cannot hold macros.

**Q.11 · Answer (B) KN Ananthapadmanabhan**
K. N. Ananthapadmanabhan, a former Kerala cricketer, was added to the ICC's International Panel of Umpires in August 2020.

**Q.12 · Answer (D) The Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences**
The Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences awards the economics prize, as it does the physics and chemistry prizes; the Swedish Academy awards literature and the Norwegian Nobel Committee peace.

**Q.13 · Answer (A) Robert Hooke**
Robert Hooke saw and named cells in a thin slice of cork in 1665.

**Q.14 · Answer (D) M3 = M1 + Net time deposits of post office savings**
M3 is M1 plus the net time deposits of commercial banks, not of post office savings. The other three are the textbook definitions: M1 is currency plus demand deposits, post office savings bank deposits are added in M2, and total post office deposits in M4.

**Q.15 · Answer (D) 6 years or the age of 62 years, whichever is earlier**
Under Article 316(2) a member of a State Public Service Commission, the chairman included, holds office for six years or until the age of 62, whichever is earlier.

**Q.16 · Answer (D) Hundru waterfall**
Hundru Falls, on the Subarnarekha near Ranchi, is in Jharkhand. Jog Falls is in Karnataka and Dudhsagar in Goa.

**Q.17 · Answer (B) football**
Laishram Manitombi Singh, from Manipur, was a footballer who played for India and captained Mohun Bagan.

**Q.18 · Answer (A) Gujarat, Narmada**
The Sardar Sarovar Dam is on the Narmada at Kevadia in Gujarat.

**Q.19 · Answer (A) Mycobacterium leprae**
Leprosy is caused by Mycobacterium leprae; Mycobacterium tuberculosis causes tuberculosis.

**Q.20 · Answer (A) Santhals**
In 1832 the British demarcated the Damin-i-Koh in the Rajmahal hills as the land of the Santhals.

**Q.21 · Answer (A) Indian Institute of Technology Madras**
IIT Madras ranked first among Institutes of National Importance in ARIIA 2020.

**Q.22 · Answer (A) Acquired immunodeficiency syndrome (AIDS)**
ELISA detects antibodies to HIV in the blood, so it is used to diagnose HIV infection and AIDS.

**Q.23 · Answer (D) Dehra Dun**
Dehra Dun, about 35-45 km long and 22-25 km wide, is the largest of the duns, the longitudinal valleys between the Shiwaliks and the Lesser Himalaya.

**Q.24 · Answer (C) Bhubaneswar**
SSC's key gives Bhubaneswar, where Odisha's Chief Minister opened a Fire Park in January 2021 to teach people, students above all, basic fire safety.

**Q.25 · Answer (C) Jigmet Dolma**
Jigmet Dolma, a runner from Ladakh, finished fourth in the Bangabandhu Dhaka Marathon in January 2021.

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